UNITED STATES COURT OF INTERNATIONAL TRADE

BEFORE: The Honorable Mark A. Barnett, Chief Judge

BGH EDELSTAHL SIEGEN GMBH, Plaintiff, v. UNITED STATES, Defendant, and ELLWOOD CITY FORGE COMPANY, et. al., Defendant-Intervenors.	Ct. No. 26-01186 Before: The Honorable Mark A. Barnett, Chief Judge
BGH EDELSTAHL SIEGEN GMBH, Plaintiff, v. UNITED STATES, Defendant, and ELLWOOD CITY FORGE COMPANY, *et. al.*, Defendant-Intervenors.	Ct. No. 26-01186

BGH EDELSTAHL SIEGEN GMBH

MOTION FOR JUDGMENT UPON THE AGENCY RECORD

Pursuant to Rule 56.2 of the Rules of this Court, Plaintiff, BGH Edelstahl Siegen GmbH ("BGH"), respectfully moves this Court for an order granting movant judgment on the agency record against Defendant, the United States (representing the U.S. Department of Commerce ("Commerce")), including, but not limited to the following relief:

BGH EDELSTAHL SIEGEN GMBH

MOTION FOR JUDGMENT UPON THE AGENCY RECORD

Pursuant to Rule 56.2 of the Rules of this Court, Plaintiff, BGH Edelstahl Siegen GmbH ("BGH"), respectfully moves this Court for an order granting movant judgment on the agency record against Defendant, the United States (representing the U.S. Department of Commerce ("Commerce")), including, but not limited to the following relief:

- Remand to Commerce to reconsider its determination treating home market sales of certain forged steel products not meeting the definitions of fluid end blocks in "finished condition" and "unfinished condition" contained in the product scope description as subject merchandise;
- Remand to Commerce to reconsider its application of a modified differential pricing analysis in this administrative review;
- Granting BGH such other relief as the Court may deem appropriate.

A memorandum of points and authorities in support of this motion is being filed contemporaneously with this motion.

WHEREFORE, for the reasons described in this motion and the accompanying memorandum in support thereof, BGH respectfully requests that the Court enter judgment in its favor. A proposed order is submitted with this motion for the Court's consideration.

Dated: September 18, 2026

UNITED STATES COURT OF INTERNATIONAL TRADE

BEFORE: The Honorable Mark A. Barnett, Chief Judge

BGH EDELSTAHL SIEGEN GMBH, Plaintiff, v. UNITED STATES, Defendant, and ELLWOOD CITY FORGE COMPANY, *et. al.*, Defendant-Intervenors.	Respectfully submitted, /s/ Marc E. Montalbine Marc E. Montalbine J. Kevin Horgan Merisa A. Horgan DEKIEFFER & HORGAN, PLLC 1015 Fifteenth Street, N.W. 6th Floor Washington, DC 20005 Tel: (202) 783-6900 Fax: (202) 783-6909 email: montalbine@dhlaw.de Counsel to BGH Edelstahl Siegen GmbH Ct. No. 26-01186 **PUBLIC VERSION** Confidential information deleted on pages 19, 20, 32 & 42.

BGH EDELSTAHL SIEGEN GMBH
RULE 56.2 MEMORANDUM IN SUPPORT OF
MOTION FOR JUDGMENT UPON THE AGENCY RECORD

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

TABLE OF CONTENTS

I. RULE 56.2 STATEMENT 1
A. Administrative Determinations Sought to be Reviewed 1
B. Issues Presented 1
II. STATEMENT OF FACTS 2
A. Original Investigation 2
B. Administrative Review 6
III. SUMMARY OF ARGUMENT 9
A. Product Scope 9
B. Differential Pricing Methodology 11
IV. ARGUMENT 11
A. Standard of Review 11
B. Commerce Improperly Treated Certain Forged Products Sold in the Home Market as Products Under Review 13
1. Statutory Framework 13
2. The Products Under Review Are Expressly Limited to Forged Steel Fluid End Blocks in Finished or Unfinished Condition 15
3. Commerce Improperly Included Home Market Sales of Military Equipment Forgings in Its Dumping Calculations 19
4. Commerce Improperly Included Home Market Sales of Forged Bars in Its Dumping Calculations 31
5. Commerce Failed to Properly Consider Differences in Product Type in Its Antidumping Calculations 34
C. Commerce Improperly Modified its Differential Pricing Methodology During the Course of this Review 35

TABLE OF AUTHORITIES

TABLE OF AUTHORITIES

Cases

Cases: **Page(s)**

ArcelorMittal Stainless Belgium N.V. v. United States,
694 F.3d 82 (Fed. Cir. 2012) 16

Atkore Steel Components, Inc. v. United States,
313 F. Supp. 3d 1374 (CIT 2018) 26

BGH Edelstahl Siegen GmbH v. United States,
804 F. Supp. 3d 1330 (CIT 2025) 18, 27

Borusan Mannesmann Boru Sanayi Ve Ticaret A.S. v. United States,
222 F. Supp. 3d 1255 (CIT 2017) 12

Burlington Truck Lines, Inc. v. United States,
371 U.S. 156 (1962) 12

Dibble v. Pennmore,
545 F.3d 208 (2d Cir. 2008) 17

Dongbu Steel Co. v. United States,
635 F.3d 1363 (Fed. Cir. 2011) 39, 45

Eckstrom Indus., Inc. v. United States,
254 F.3d 1068 (Fed. Cir. 2001) 10, 12, 21

Garg Tube Exp. LLP v. United States,
740 F. Supp. 3d 1355 (CIT 2024) 11

Interval Licensing LLC v. AOL, Inc.,
766 F.3d 1364 (Fed. Cir. 2014) 17

Jiaxing Brother Fastener Co. v. United States,
822 F.3d 1289 (Fed. Cir. 2016) 12

King Supply Co., LLC v. United States,
674 F.3d 1343 (Fed. Cir. 2012) 27, 28

Loper Bright Enterprises v. Raimondo,
144 S.Ct. 2244 (2024) 11

Marmen Inc. v. United States,
134 F.4th 1334 (Fed. Cir. 2025) ..... *passim*

Statutes:

19 U.S.C. § 1673 (1994) 9

I. RULE 56.2 STATEMENT

Pursuant to Rule 56.2(c)(1) of the Rules of this Court, Plaintiff, BGH Edelstahl Siegen GmbH ("BGH" or "BGH Siegen"), hereby states the administrative decision sought to be reviewed and the issues of law presented:

A. Administrative Determinations Sought to be Reviewed

The U.S. Department of Commerce ("Commerce") published its contested final results of administrative review in the *Federal Register* on January 27, 2026. *Forged Steel Fluid End Blocks from the Federal Republic of Germany: Final Results of the Antidumping Duty Administrative Review; 2023*, 91 Fed. Reg. 3433 (Jan. 27, 2026) ("Final Results"); *see also* Memorandum (Jan. 20, 2026) ("Final IDM") (PR 3 & 4).[1] The weighted-average dumping margin assigned to BGH was 11.92%.

B. Issues Presented

1. Issue One: Whether Commerce erred in treating home market sales of certain forged steel products not meeting the definitions of fluid end blocks in "finished condition" and "unfinished condition" contained in the product scope description as subject merchandise?
2. Issue Two: Whether Commerce's revised differential pricing analysis, applied late in this administrative review, is contrary to law and unsupported by substantial evidence on the record?

II. STATEMENT OF FACTS

This proceeding involves the administrative review of the antidumping order on Forged Steel Fluid End Blocks from Germany for the period covering January to December 2023 (i.e., calendar year 2023). This proceeding involves the administrative review of the antidumping order on *Forged Steel Fluid End Blocks from Germany* for the period covering January to December 2023 (*i.e.*,

[1] In accordance with the Chambers Procedures of this Court, citations to the confidential record are designated as "CR" and citations to the public record are designated as "PR".

calendar year 2023).

A. Original Investigation

The product scope applicable to this current administrative review has its genesis in the antidumping and countervailing duty petitions filed by the FEB Fair Trade Coalition, Elwood Group and Finkl Steel ("Petitioners") in December 2019. These original petitions described the scope of subject merchandise as fluid end blocks ("FEBs"), whether unfinished, semi-finished, or finished. Commerce had numerous questions on how to identify unfinished and semi-finished fluid end blocks, and the Petitioners responded to these questions by submitting an amendment to their antidumping and countervailing duty petitions. *See* Amendment of Petitions and Response to Commerce's Supplemental Questions, (Dec. 30, 2019) ("Petition Amendment") (contained in Section A Questionnaire Response, App. A-2 (June 20, 2024) ("Section A Response")) (PR 58).

For example, Commerce specifically directed Petitioners to "add a definition of what constitutes an unfinished fluid end block in the scope language for clarification purposes." Petition Amendment, 4 (PR 58). In response to this request, Petitioners submitted an amended scope definition removing the reference to "semi-finished" fluid end blocks and adding specific definitions for "finished condition" and "unfinished condition." These definitions state:

> A fluid end block may be imported in finished condition (i.e., ready for incorporation into a pump fluid end assembly without further finishing operations) or unfinished condition (i.e., forged but still requiring one or more finishing operations before it is ready for incorporation into a pump fluid end assembly).

Request For Information, App. III (May 14, 2024) ("Questionnaire") (PR 65).

Commerce also asked Petitioners to "Please expand your discussion of the domestic like product to explain why unfinished and semi-finished fluid end blocks should be part of the same domestic like product as finished fluid end blocks." Petition Amendment, 5 (PR 58). Petitioners responded that:

> The product scope covers FEBs whether in finished or unfinished form. All FEBs - whether in finished or unfinished form - comprise a single like product.

The Commission has explained that its "semi-finished analysis generally is appropriate for consideration of whether to define a like product as encompassing both upstream (i.e., semifinished) and downstream (i.e., finished) products." The five factors

domestic like product as finished fluid end blocks." Petition Amendment 5 (PR 58). Petitioners responded that:

> The product scope covers FEBs "whether in finished or unfinished form." All FEBs - whether in finished or unfinished form - comprise a single like product.
>
> The Commission has explained that its "semi-finished analysis generally is appropriate for consideration of whether to define a like product as encompassing both upstream (i.e., semi-finished) and downstream (i.e., finished) products." The five factors considered under this analysis are: (1) whether the upstream article is dedicated to the production of the downstream article, or has independent uses; (2) whether there are perceived to be separate markets for the upstream and downstream article; (3) differences in the physical characteristics and functions of the upstream and downstream articles; (4) differences in the cost or value of the vertically differentiated articles; and (5) the significance and extent of the process used to transform the upstream article into the downstream article.
>
> The act of forging steel of a particular chemistry, within the dimensional ranges referenced in the scope, imparts the essential character of the fluid end block. Once these essential operations are performed, the FEB is dedicated for eventual use in the fluid end assembly of a hydraulic pump. Furthermore, ***there are no separate markets or functions for unfinished FEBs as distinct from finished FEBs*** - *i.e.*, they are all sold to pump manufacturers. The only difference is the extent to which the forger or the pump manufacturer elects to perform the finishing functions. Finally, while such finishing operations are not trivial, the cost and value of the fluid end block is principally defined by the manufacturing operations performed by the forger in producing the unfinished FEB.

Id. at 6-7 (citations omitted) (emphasis added) (PR 58).

Representatives for the Petitioners also gave sworn testimony on the limited nature of the product scope at the Staff Conference of the U.S. International Trade Commission ("ITC") during the original injury investigation on January 9, 2020. In response to questions posed by James Stamps, ITC International Trade Analyst, petitioners' representatives stated as follows:

> MR. STAMPS: Thank you. Can unfinished FEB forgings be used for anything else other than for the production of finished FEBs?
>
> MR. SHIRLEY: Mark Shirley, Finkl Steel. No. Once it's forged out to a block like Mr. Boyd described, it is fully dedicated to becoming an FEB.

III. SUMMARY OF ARGUMENT

A. Product Scope

In its final results, Commerce improperly treated certain forged products (Military Equipment Forgings and forged bars) sold in the home market as "subject merchandise" and included sales of these products in its margin calculations even though these products did not meet the definitions of fluid end blocks in "finished condition" and "unfinished condition" contained in the product scope

meet the definitions of finished and unfinished condition" and "unfinished condition" were specifically added to the product scope at the request of Commerce in order to clarify "what constitutes an unfinished fluid end block in the scope language." See Petition Amendment, 4-5 (PR 58). These definitions also embodied Petitioners' sworn statements that "unfinished fluid end blocks" were "dedicated for eventual use in the fluid end assembly of a hydraulic pump" and that "there are no separate markets or functions for unfinished FEBs as distinct from finished FEBs." Id. at 6. Accordingly, these definitions serve as limiting requirements that must be fulfilled in determining subject merchandise and form a crucial part of the product scope description.

Commerce therefore erred when it simply ignored these specific definitions of "finished condition" and "unfinished condition" in determining that Military Equipment Forgings and forged bars fell within the scope description of the antidumping duty order. See *Eckstrom Indus. v. United States*, 254 F.3d 1068, 1073 (Fed. Cir. 2001) (stating that Commerce errs when it treats limiting language in the scope of an antidumping order as mere surplusage).

Commerce's inclusion of Military Equipment Forgings and forged bars within the scope of this proceeding also serves to expand the scope beyond the limits of the ITC injury determination in contravention of *Wheatland Tube*. See *Wheatland Tube Co. v. United States*, 973 F. Supp. 149, 158 (CIT 1997), *aff'd*, 161 F.3d 1365 (Fed. Cir. 1998) (citing 19 U.S.C. § 1673 (1994)). Having argued a narrow construction of the product scope in order to obtain findings of material injury, Petitioners cannot now seek a broader interpretation of the product scope during enforcement of the orders in an administrative review.

B. Differential Pricing Methodology

Commerce's introduction of a modified differential pricing methodology at the end of this proceeding, after issuance of the preliminary results and the close of briefing, violated PCH's rights of due process. Commerce's revised differential pricing analysis also continues to suffer from the same lack of statistical analysis and significance as found by the U.S. Court of Appeals for the Federal Circuit in *Marmen*. Indeed, in abandoning all statistical criteria and simply applying irrebuttable thresholds, Commerce has made its analysis less precise and incapable of determining any pattern of

reasonable mind might accept as adequate to support a conclusion." Eckstrom Indus., Inc. v. United States, 254 F.3d 1068, 1071 (Fed. Cir. 2001).

Each administrative review is a separate segment of an antidumping proceeding with its own, unique administrative record. Jiaxing Brother Fastener Co. v. United States, 822 F.3d 1289, 1299 (Fed. Cir. 2016). A determination must be supported by substantial evidence based on the administrative record of the specific review in question. Shenzhen Xinboda Indus. Co. v. United States, 456 F. Supp. 3d 1272, 1285 n.22 (CIT 2020).

Judicial review of agency action is limited to "the grounds that the agency invoked when it took the action." Michigan v. EPA, 576 U.S. 743, 758 (2015) (citing Sec. & Exch. Comm'n v. Chenery Corp., 318 U.S. 80, 87 (1943)). An "administrative order cannot be upheld unless the grounds upon which the agency acted in exercising its powers were those upon which its action can be sustained." Chenery, 318 U.S. at 95. "An agency's determination thus cannot be sustained on the basis of a rationale supplied after the fact - whether by the agency's litigation counsel, by another party, or by the court." Borusan Mannesmann Boru Sanayi Ve Ticaret A.S. v. United States, 222 F. Supp. 3d 1255, 1267 (CIT 2017) (citing Burlington Truck Lines, Inc. v. United States, 371 U.S. 156, 168-69 (1962)).

An agency violates the arbitrary and capricious standard when it fails entirely to consider a party's arguments. See Provisur Techs., Inc. v. Weber, Inc., 50 F.4th 117, 123-24 (Fed. Cir. 2022) (finding that the Patent Trial and Appeal Board violated the APA with its failure to address a party's arguments regarding patent invalidity and remanding for further proceedings). A court may not take the place of the agency by analyzing and disposing of such forgotten issues. Rather, the court must remand such issues back to the agency for further consideration.

IV. ARGUMENT

A. Standard of Review

court." Accordingly, Commerce's revised differential pricing analysis is contrary to law and not supported by the administrative record in this review.

An agency violates the arbitrary and capricious standard when it fails entirely to consider a party's arguments. See *Provisur Techs., Inc. v. Weber, Inc.*, 50 F.4th 117, 123-24 (Fed. Cir. 2022) (finding that the Patent Trial and Appeal Board violated the APA with its failure to address a party's arguments regarding prosecution history and remanding for the agency to make the place of the agency by analyzing and disposing of such forgotten issues. Rather, the court must remand such issues back to the agency for further consideration.

V. Conclusion and Prayer for Relief

For the reasons stated above, Commerce's final results are not supported by substantial evidence on the administrative record or in accordance with the law or other applicable legal standards. We therefore respectfully request that the Court remand this case to Commerce for redetermination with instructions consistent with the arguments set forth above and grant BGH such other further relief as the Court may deem appropriate.

V. CONCLUSION AND PRAYER FOR RELIEF

For the reasons stated above, Commerce's final results are not supported by substantial evidence on the administrative record or in accordance with the law or other applicable legal standards. We therefore respectfully request that the Court remand this case to Commerce for redetermination with instructions consistent with the arguments set forth above and grant BGH such other further relief as the Court may deem appropriate.

Dated: September 18, 2026

Respectfully submitted,

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Word Count Certificate of Compliance

This brief has been prepared utilizing Word for Microsoft 365 using a proportionally spaced typeface (12 point Times New Roman font).

In accordance with the Chambers Procedures of this Court, the undersigned certifies that this brief complies with the word limitations set forth in the amended scheduling order dated August 26, 2026 (ECF No. 23). Specifically, excluding those exempted portions of the brief, as set forth in section 2(B)(1) of the Chambers Procedures, I hereby certify that this brief contains **13,834** words. In accordance with the Chambers Procedures, this certified word count is based on the word count feature in the word processing system (Microsoft Word) used to prepare this brief.

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